
**NOTE: WHERE THERE IS MORE THAN ONE JUMP WITHIN A BRANCHPOINT BOX,
THE JUMPS ARE TO BE APPLIED IN ORDER FROM THE TOP.**

MAJOR FLOW CONTROL, CONDITION AND FILL VARIABLES *

Z283_VBSConsent (1=Ask consent, 5=Do not ask consent)

Note: If the interview is suspended before reaching section W, these questions be handled in SurveyTrak and the results assigned into V562xx1 in the Blaise instrument.

Rules for VBS administration are:

W797_VBS BRANCHPOINT: ASK IF
Z283_VBSConsent = EMPTY and
THIS IS A SELF INTERVIEW (A009=1) and
R is not in a NH (A028 NOT 1) and
R resides in the US (Country is blank or Country = 'US') and
State/territory is NOT equal to any of the following: AK, HI, AS, FM, GU, MH,
MP, PW, PR, VI
ELSE GO TO END OF IW (IWComplete)

W797_VBS

Lastly, we ask you to provide a small sample of blood, less than two fluid ounces, to be drawn by a trained health professional at your home within the next few weeks. The blood sample will be used for research purposes only and will not be used for profit. You will receive a report from the blood analysis, including the results from routine tests such as cholesterol and blood sugar, similar to one you might receive from your doctor.

If you agree to this part of our research, you will be contacted by an employee of Provant Health, an established company with a team of trained medical professionals, who will arrange for a visit to collect the blood sample. The visit will take about [time] minutes during which you will be asked to sign an acknowledgement of this consent. You will receive [dollar amount] as a token of our appreciation for participating in this component of HRS.

The risks associated with drawing blood are minimal, and include momentary discomfort and/or bruising. Although you may not directly benefit from being in this study, others may ultimately benefit from the research it will allow.

Analysis will be performed by the Advanced Research and Diagnostic Laboratory at the University of Minnesota and other laboratories. This includes analysis of DNA, which holds the instructions the body uses to grow and function. Genetic markers will be extracted from the blood for future tests which may include genome sequencing.

Results of this research will be kept strictly confidential in the same way as the information you've provided in this interview. No names or other identifiers will be used. The samples you provide will be stored at the University of Michigan and other repositories indefinitely. Participation in the blood draw is completely voluntary. You will provide a blood sample only if you choose to do so. You are not required to do this, and can stop participation at any time without forfeiting your token of appreciation.

This research is funded by the National Institute of Health (NIH) and has been reviewed by the University of Michigan Health Sciences and Behavioral Sciences Institutional Review Board. Disclosure of your research information may only occur in limited specific instances. In addition, a Federal law, called the Genetic Information Nondiscrimination Act (GINA), makes it illegal to discriminate against you based on your genetic information.

Further information about this request was provided to you in the HRS Study Information Brochure. Be sure that all of your questions and concerns have been answered.

If you have further questions about this request, you may contact the HRS project team toll free at the University of Michigan at 1-866-611-6476.

Do you agree to provide a blood sample for this study?

1. Yes
5. No

END OF HRS MAIN INTERVIEW

Q×Q:

Q: Will I get paid to do this?

Yes, a \$50 check will be sent to you. You should receive it around the time when you are contacted by Provant Health to schedule your draw.

Q: Will I get my results?

Yes. In addition to the \$50 token of appreciation, we will share the results obtained from your sample.

If you participate, we will be able to provide you a report of approximately 25 different analyses which you can review yourself and/or share with your health professional.

Your results will be available within 1 to 3 weeks after the sample collection.

Q: Who will collect my blood?

In the next several weeks you will be contacted by an employee of Provant Health, an established company with a team of trained medical professionals, who will arrange for a visit to collect the blood sample.

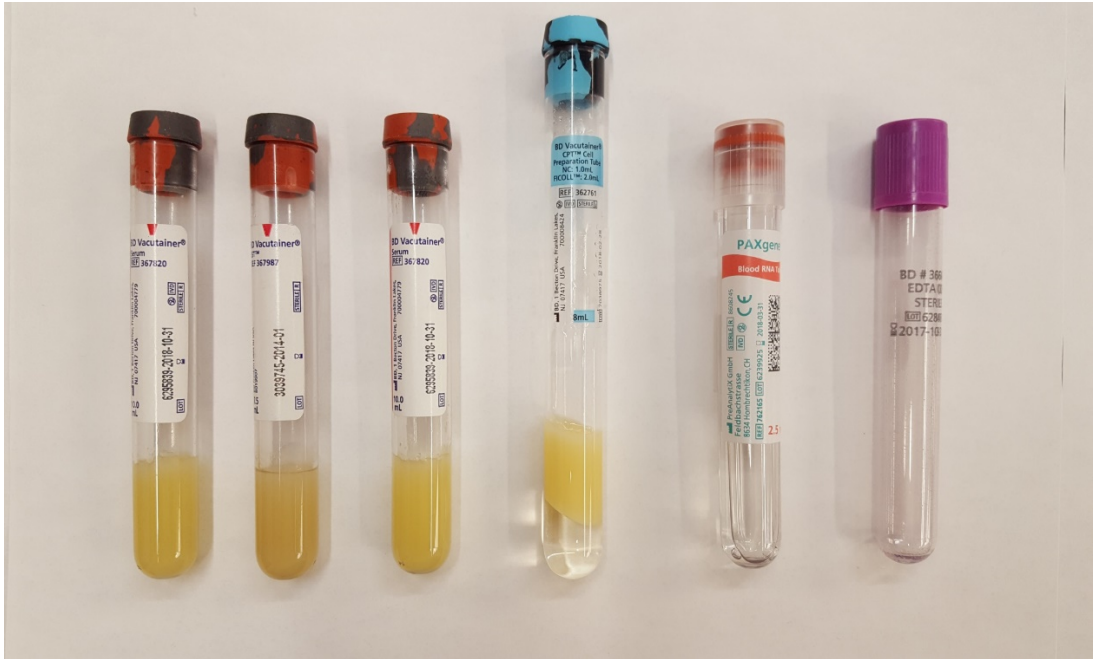
Q: How much blood will be collected and how long will it take?

We will collect an amount similar to that normally taken by your doctor to run a routine panel of tests. Specifically, we will collect 43 mL (which is about 1 fluid ounce or 3 tablespoons), which will be drawn into six separate vials. The visit will last roughly 30 minutes.

Q: Why are six vials needed?

These samples are collected for research purposes, and multiple vials are needed to meet the processing/storage needs of the different types of analyses which are conducted. The set of six vials used amounts to 43 mL of blood (which is about 1 fluid ounce or 3 tablespoons). Some of the vials look a little large, though many are partially pre-filled with solvents/preservatives.

This amount of blood is relatively small, but collecting six vials allows us to provide each participating respondent a report of approximately 25 different results, which you can review yourself and/or share with your doctor. [\[Share image below if needed\]](#)



Q: Do I need to prepare (e.g., fast)?

The health professional will provide more information and answer any questions you may have when they contact you to schedule the visit. They may ask you to fast overnight. If so, they will schedule the draw in the morning before breakfast; they will also give you specific instructions for what to do after the draw. You can alert them of any medical conditions you think they should be aware of. Even if you are unable to fast, we will still collect your sample.

Q: What results will I receive?

The analyses done on your whole blood sample are similar to those which your doctor may conduct on a routine, comprehensive blood test. You will receive the results of approximately 25 different tests, as well as indicators of whether each result is within the normal range.

Examples of the results you will receive include: White/red blood cell counts, total/HDL/LDL cholesterol, sodium/potassium readings and blood sugar levels.

[Reference – Complete list of WBD Results in Respondent Letter] <i>Not generally to be shared, but available for reference</i>		
White Blood Cell Count	Albumin	HDL-Cholesterol, Direct-Measure
Red Blood Cell Count	Alkaline phosphatase	Creatinine
Hemoglobin	Aspartate Aminotransferase	Ferritin
Hematocrit	Bicarbonate (CO2)	Glucose, Fasting
Mean Corpuscular Volume	Calcium	Potassium
Mean Corpuscular Hemoglobin Concentration	Chloride	Protein, Total
Red Cell Distribution Width	Cholesterol, Total	Sodium
Platelet Count	Triglycerides	Bilirubin, Total
Alanine Aminotransferase	LDL-Cholesterol, Calculated	Urea Nitrogen (BUN)

Q: Will I have to go anywhere to give the blood sample?

You do not need to go anywhere. The health professional will setup an appointment to visit you at home or any other place you may suggest as convenient for you.

Q: Can I have time to think about it? Who can I talk to get more information?

I need to record whether you agree to provide your sample. If you agree, you will be contacted by the Health Professional and you could tell them that you changed your mind. We appreciate your participation in this important part of our study and hope that our token of appreciation and the results obtained from your sample would make your time worthwhile.

You can contact the HRS staff to obtain more information by calling our toll-free number 1-866-611-6476.

Whole Blood Draw Overview

HRS has received funding to collect a small blood sample from HRS panel respondents. This sample, referred to as a whole (venous) blood draw (“WBD”), will be collected by a licensed health professional on a separate visit after the main HRS interview. Analysis of the whole blood sample will provide information about health and aging, as well as allowing for extraction of DNA and RNA for genetic studies. The respondents will benefit from receiving a report of approximately 25 different analyses which they can review themselves and/or share with their doctor.

Whole Blood Draw Consent

Only respondents who consent to participate in the whole blood draw will be contacted and visited by a health professional. The consent to participate in the whole blood draw will be presented in SurveyTrak to all panel respondents and new spouses who complete a self-interview in either English or Spanish, do not report living in a nursing home, live in the United States (except Hawaii and Alaska), and did not successfully provide a sample in 2016. The consent is verbal - interviewers will not be obtaining a signature but need to indicate accurately whether the respondent agrees or does not agree to participate in the whole blood draw by selecting a Yes or No answer in SurveyTrak on the following screen.

SurveyTrak Whole Blood Consent Text (English Version):

Lastly, we ask you to provide a small sample of blood, less than two fluid ounces, to be drawn by a trained health professional at your home within the next few weeks. The blood sample will be used for research purposes only and will not be used for profit. The blood will be stored in a repository for future analyses. You will receive a report from the blood analysis, including the results from routine tests such as cholesterol and blood sugar, similar to one you might receive from your doctor.

If you agree to this part of our research, you will be contacted by an employee of Provant Health, an established company with a team of trained medical professionals, who will arrange for a visit to collect the blood sample. The visit will take about [time] minutes. You will receive [dollar amount] as a token of our appreciation for participating in this component of HRS. Genetic markers will be extracted from the blood for future tests which may include genome sequencing.

Although you may not directly benefit from being in this study, others may ultimately benefit from the research it will allow.

The risks associated with drawing blood are minimal, and include momentary discomfort and/or bruising. Results of this research will be kept strictly confidential in the same way as the information you’ve provided in this interview. No names or other identifiers will be used.

Participation in the blood draw is completely voluntary. You will provide a blood sample only if you choose to do so. You are not required to do this, and can stop participation at any time without forfeiting your token of appreciation.

This research has been reviewed by the University of Michigan Health Sciences and Behavioral Sciences Institutional Review Board. A Certificate of Confidentiality has been obtained from the Department of Health and Human Services for this study. In addition, a Federal law, called the Genetic Information Nondiscrimination Act (GINA), makes it illegal to discriminate against you based on your genetic information.

Further information about this request was provided to you in the HRS Study Information Brochure. Be sure that all of your questions and concerns have been answered.

If you have further questions about this request, you may contact the HRS Survey Director, Nicole Kirgis, toll free at the University of Michigan at 1-866-611-6476.

After reading the screen, interviewers enter the outcome of the whole blood draw request.

“Do you agree to provide a blood sample for this study?”

- *Yes*
- *No*

The whole blood consent screen will also be viewable as a View/Edit tab in SurveyTrak. It will not be editable via the View/Edit option but it is accessible to interviewers in case a respondent calls after his/her interview and has a question or concerns.

What’s next?

Respondents who agree to provide a whole blood sample will receive a \$50 token of appreciation and their contact information will be passed to Provant Health, a long-standing company with a national team of trained medical professionals who will make an appointment to visit the respondent and administer the draw. Most respondents should be contacted by Provant Health within 1 – 2 weeks of completing their HRS interview.

The Provant Health health professional will obtain the respondent’s signed authorization to conduct the draw, complete the blood draw, and mail the samples directly to our laboratory at the University of Minnesota for analysis.

The \$50 token of appreciation is not dependent upon the respondent’s actual participation in the whole blood draw. The payment will appear in the payment wizard at the completion of the interview and needs to be confirmed. We prefer sending checks to all respondents but interviewers may select a different type of payment in the payment wizard or via the payments menu (accessible via the Edit→Payments in SurveyTrak).

Whole Blood Draw Cooperation

Whole blood draw is a very important component of HRS and will provide extensive information about the aging process. We count on interviewers to properly introduce this component and highlight the benefits to respondents. **The main benefit for respondents is receiving a broad set of results**—we will be able to provide a report of approximately 25 different analyses which respondents can review themselves and/or share with their doctor.

Be prepared when asking for the whole blood consent. Review the materials which will be provided to you at the in-person training: (a) The Study Brochure, which includes information about the whole blood sample, and (b) the list of Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) which will assist you in answering any questions the respondent might have about this component.

Summary of Document Changes

Date	Author	Description
2/16/2018	Gary H	Updated Blood to 43 ml, removed references to DBS, Replaced Hooper Holmes with Provant Health, updated consent language.